MAKE IT DO · FREE SHEET

# What things cost the year you were born

# 1937

| IN 1937 | THE RECORD | TODAY | IN OUR HOUSE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **A pound of white bread**<br>per pound | 8.6¢ | **$1.87**<br>per pound | |
| **A dozen eggs**<br>per dozen | 36¢ | **$4.25**<br>per dozen | |
| **Half a gallon of milk**<br>delivered to the door | 25¢ | **$2.03**<br>half a gallon, at the store | |
| **A pound of butter**<br>per pound | 41¢ | **$4.76**<br>per pound | |
| **A pound of round steak**<br>per pound | 39¢ | **$8.86**<br>per pound | |
| **A pound of bacon**<br>per pound | 41¢ | **$7.02**<br>per pound | |
| **A pound of coffee**<br>per pound | 26¢ | **$8.18**<br>per pound | |
| **Five pounds of sugar**<br>5-pound bag | 28¢ | **$5.12**<br>5 pounds | |
| **Ten pounds of potatoes**<br>10-pound bag | 28¢ | **$9.63**<br>10 pounds | |
| **A stamp for a letter**<br>first-class, first ounce | 3¢ | **82¢**<br>Forever stamp | |

THE NAMES IN THE HOSPITAL NURSERY, 1937

**Girls:** Mary, Barbara, Patricia, Shirley, Betty. **Boys:** Robert, James, John, William, Richard.

One dollar in 1937 buys about what **$22.36** buys today (consumer price index, 2025 average). The last column is yours: write in what it cost in your house.

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**Where every number comes from.** U.S. Bureau of the Census, Historical Statistics of the United States, Colonial Times to 1970, Part 1, p. 213, series E 188, 189, 192, 193, 194, 195, 197, 200, 202 (retail food prices, BLS); United States Postal Service, Historian, "Rates for Domestic Letters Since 1863" (September 2021), Table "Postage in Cents, per Ounce" (effective dates), p. 1 (single-page PDF). Today: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics average prices, 2025 average; USPS 2026.

From the Make It Do film
*Everyday Life in 1950s America,*
*in Real Color Film*